REQUIREMENTS & USE CASE MODELLING

WUA Student Support and Service Request System

Selected user stories

ID and title	Primary actor	Purpose
US02 — Submit a Service Request	Student	Submit a routine service issue in a structured form.
US03 — View My Service Requests	Student	View and track only the student's own submitted requests.
US05 — Update Request Status	Authorized service staff	Record request progress so that status information remains current and traceable.

Detailed use case descriptions

Use Case 1: Submit a Service Request (US02)

Field	Description
Use case ID	UC01
Use case name	Submit a Service Request
Related user story	US02
Primary actor	Student
Goal	Submit a routine service issue and receive a reference number and confirmation.
Preconditions	1. Student has an active account and is signed in. 2. At least one request category is available. 3. The system can accept and store requests.
Trigger	Student selects "Submit a Service Request".
Postconditions — success	A request is saved with a unique reference number, owner, category, description, timestamp, and initial status "Submitted". A confirmation is displayed.
Postconditions — failure	Invalid data is not saved as a completed request. The system does not show a success message or reference number for an unsaved request.

Main success flow

1. Student opens the new service request page.

2. System displays the form and available categories.
3. Student selects a category and enters a description.
4. Student submits the form.
5. System validates required fields and checks description length/content.
6. System creates the request and generates a unique reference number.
7. System saves the request with status “Submitted” and records the date/time.
8. System displays confirmation and the reference number.

Alternative and exception flows

ID	Condition	System response
A1	A required field is missing.	Highlight the missing field, explain what is required, and do not create the request. The student can correct the form.
A2	Description is blank, whitespace-only, or too long.	Display a validation message and ask the student to revise the description.
A3	Student session has expired.	Require sign-in again; do not submit under an unidentified account.
A4	Saving fails because of a system/database error.	Display a safe error message, do not show a reference number for an unsaved request, and allow a retry.
A5	No categories are available.	Explain that submission is temporarily unavailable and provide an appropriate next step.

Use Case 2: View My Service Requests (US03)

Field	Description
Use case ID	UC02
Use case name	View My Service Requests
Related user story	US03
Primary actor	Student
Goal	View submitted requests and check their current statuses.
Preconditions	1. Student is signed in. 2. System can retrieve request data.
Trigger	Student selects “My Service Requests”.
Postconditions — success	The system displays the student’s own requests and summary details. No request data is changed.
Postconditions — exception	If retrieval fails, the system reports the problem without exposing another student’s information.

Main success flow

1. Student opens “My Service Requests”.

2. System identifies the student from the authenticated session.
3. System retrieves requests owned by that student only.
4. System displays each request's reference number, category, submission date, and current status.
5. Student selects a request to view its details.
6. System displays permitted details and student-visible update history.
7. Student reviews the status and may return to the list.

Alternative and exception flows

ID	Condition	System response
A1	Student has not submitted any requests.	Display an empty-state message and offer the option to submit a request.
A2	Student attempts to open a request owned by another student.	Deny access without revealing request details. Enforce the ownership check on the server, not only in the interface.
A3	Session has expired.	Require sign-in before displaying request information.
A4	Request list cannot be loaded.	Display a clear temporary error and a retry option.
A5	Reference is invalid or unavailable to the student.	Display a general "Request not found or unavailable" message without disclosing private information.

Use Case 3: Update Request Status (US05)

Field	Description
Use case ID	UC03
Use case name	Update Request Status
Related user story	US05
Primary actor	Authorized service staff member
Goal	Record the latest progress of a service request.
Preconditions	1. Staff member is signed in. 2. Staff member has permission to manage the request. 3. The request exists.
Trigger	Staff member opens a request and selects a new status.
Postconditions — success	New status and timestamp are saved. History records the change and staff identity. The student can see the student-visible status.
Postconditions — failure	An unauthorized or invalid update is not saved; the previous valid status remains unchanged.

Main success flow

1. Staff member opens the staff request dashboard.
2. System displays requests the staff member is authorized to access.
3. Staff member selects a request and reviews its details.
4. Staff member chooses a permitted status, such as "In Progress", "Awaiting Information", "Resolved", or "Closed".

5. System verifies staff permissions and validates the status transition.
6. System saves the status and records date/time and staff identity in the request history.
7. System confirms the update succeeded.
8. Updated status becomes visible to the student in “My Service Requests”.

Alternative and exception flows

ID	Condition	System response
A1	User lacks staff permission.	Reject the update and leave the request unchanged.
A2	Selected status is not permitted from the current status.	Explain that the transition is invalid and present permitted choices.
A3	Request no longer exists or cannot be accessed.	Display an unavailable-request message and return staff member to the list.
A4	Saving the update fails.	Report that the update was not saved; do not show success or create a misleading history entry.
A5	Another staff member updates the request at the same time.	Reload the latest status and ask the staff member to review and retry rather than silently overwriting the newer update.

4. UML use case diagram

